

SIMPLE RED SAUCE

MAKES 2.25 kg	ACTIVE TIME 30 min	TOTAL TIME 30 min
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DETAILS

- Tags: vegan

INGREDIENTS

75 g	Extra-virgin olive oil
40 g	Garlic, thinly sliced
quantity not given	Dried red chile flakes
2382 g	Whole San Marzano tomatoes, crushed by hand, from three 794 g cans
quantity not given	Salt

METHOD

- Put a Dutch oven, or any heavy pot of that size, on a low flame. In go the oil and the garlic, gently, for 30 seconds to a minute, until the smell comes up but before any colour does. Add chile flakes to taste.
- Tip in the tomatoes with all their juice and hold it on low for 25 to 30 minutes. You are not reducing it, only letting the flavours come together. Salt to taste.
- Take it off the heat and use it, or cool it and store it.

NOTES

The brief here is thirty minutes and a short shopping list, with nothing dominating. It should work on rigatoni, inside a lasagna, and ladled into a braise.

Do not let the garlic colour. The whole character of the sauce turns if it browns.

Resist reducing it. Twenty-five to thirty minutes on low is about blending, not thickening.

This is the one to settle your preferred tomato brand, house olive oil and garlic level on, so treat the quantities as a starting point.

Vegan as written.

Used by the eggplant mezzelune.

PRESERVING

Nine cups is far more than one dish needs, which is the point. Portion the surplus the day you make it.

Cool completely, then keep airtight in the fridge up to 5 days.

Freeze up to a month. Portion before freezing, sized to one dish.

A frozen portion goes straight into the pan over low heat, no thawing needed.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

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